

RAJAT KULSHRESHTHA

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EXPERIENCE

*In leadership, I strive to **bring personal value propositions** that go beyond routine tasks and **have tangible impact on people, process and technology**. **Collaboration** with team and leadership is key to **building consensus** on this value proposition. Once defined, I **drive it to closure** by ensuring that my initiatives **create visible, measurable results**.*

PAYPAL INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED

Bengaluru, KA

Manager, Software Development (PayPal Activity Services Team)

07/22-09/26

- **Directly managed a team of 10+ engineers (over 4+ years)** delivering strategic initiatives, product enhancements, key technical roadmap items and meeting run the business goals. **Owned transaction listing, search and details APIs** across PayPal UX powering **engagement of 32%+ in app** and another **27%+ engagement via emails** in post transaction experiences.
- **Swiftly delivered 90+ Product, 25+ Strategic, 35+ Security, 10+ Tech excellence and Innovation** initiatives by **indirectly managing 30+ engineers** in a cohesive and high-functioning **end-to-end fullstack product** model. Stepped up to **institute Product-Program-Engineering sync ups** to review OKRs progress, risk mitigation planning and resource planning that **enables leads to represent independently** in shared cadences across stakeholders.
- Designed processes to **achieve fast-paced and high quality deliveries**. Supported **over 500+ Jira tickets, 1.5k+ queries**, ensured zero P0/P1 in product, continual **99.995% availability** of critical business functionalities and **low latencies** in client facing interfaces. **Refined process & tech solutions** to handle exceptions, **alerting and triage within a small time frame**. Attained **high work life balance**, less interruptions and peaceful weekends/holidays.
- **Nominated** at Senior Director+ level **for leading a cross-geo diverse 7+ member team** across backend, web and app to build a scalable platform that **drives PayPal's** highest priority **fight against Spam**. Demonstrated **distributed-team leadership** and leveraged data oriented, process driven and highly agile philosophy to **deliver this end-to-end with a month prior** to target timeline.
- Leading **>70% of Inbound intakes across multiple stacks** as a trusted leadership peer, to steer, plan, allocate resources and deliver enterprise strategic initiatives. **Accelerate program alignment by 50%+** via deep understanding of enterprise strategic & product goals, architectural patterns, solution design and discovery.
- **Share status** of current releases, monthly goals, team burn down charts, risks and mitigation plan, quarterly roadmaps **with senior executives on weekly basis**. Convince and **persuade on matters of strategic** and operational importance.
- Encouraged **architects to pursue 8 tech initiatives** in platform vision from 2023-2026 **that aligns with business strategy**, and, **120+ Product requesters to fine tune requirements** based on ROI in short, medium and long term with adherence to compliance and governance.
- Conceptualized practices to improve **sprint throughput by >25%** and improved **say-do ratio by >70%**. **Slashed 3+ year old product backlog of 100+ tickets** incorporating product and customer feedback, **secured 10+ Merchants of \$5M+ TPV back on PayPal**.
- Repeatedly **went out of the way** in supporting cross-functional teams and stakeholders for solving issues faced by high volume merchants including **Google, Apple, Meta, Plaid, Shopify, FedEx, BigCommerce, Temu** etc. to meet PayPal's shared commitment of customer satisfaction. Titled with **One PayPal in Action** and called as **favorite partners to work with** across cross-functional orgs.
- **Developed and deployed strategic platform initiatives**, setting a clear **performance measure of 99%-ile data within <8 secs** in Activities cached data. Led multi-year initiatives to **curb platform legacy cost** and **uplift systems performance over 20%+**.
- **Managed**, re-designed and addressed **performance bottlenecks in a Tier-1 system** to realize **3x throughput, USD 300K+ savings/year**, reduced **450+ VMs** and **50%+ drop in CPU**. **Innovated** a performance and cost efficient **plug-n-play shadow framework** that **allows rapid internal re-architecture for scaling**.
- **Represented** our business unit in **leadership visits, presentations**; and wider engineering group in **hosting CTO talk**. Organized and coached the team to present for CTO, CIO, VPs, Sr Directors, and in 40+ internal sessions.
- Recruited and **managed headcount** by close collaboration with HR and leadership to **hire 10, laid off 4, promoted 3** and **repositioned 2** engineers to ascertain org's success, individual's growth and lowering center costs. Performed continuous team assessment, strengths identification and stack ranking of individuals.
- **Build the next generation**, coach teammates to **build multiple skill dimensions** and expand them to the next level. Embed processes to capture feedback from stakeholders and leadership. **Mentor with monthly 1:1** conversations, refining goals and **sharing structured feedback** to reflect and focus on growth & wellbeing. Impart a **culture of team's recognition** within Dir+ org and peer groups. **Celebrated milestones** with team

lunches, dinners, outings and group activities to nourish the one team culture.

- Built a strong **technical internship** project **charter**, onboarded and guided **5 interns** with peer-mentors within the team. Achieved high Intern project appreciation score, happiness index and 100% **secured a PPO** at PayPal.

PAYPAL INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED

Bengaluru, KA

Member of Technical Staff 1 (PayPal Activity Services Team)

03/22-06/22

- **Steered** a small team for the migration of post transaction engagement feature, "Actions in Activities", from **Strong to Eventual consistency model**. Strategised the execution with data driven decisioning and engineered end-to-end design and delivery. **Trimmed 70% latency, savings of USD 480,000 per annum**, cut down **Billion+ daily real time API calls** and **6 Billion+ daily DB SQL** and improved availability and performance of actions capability to **four 9's** in long term.
- **Designed and launched** platform enhancement to allow **GraphQL** based loading on Activities detail page. **Eliminated visible latency by 1+ sec**, avoiding **60+ real time API calls** and instituted higher platform availability, performance & scale.
- **ROI evaluation** for ES Infra cost to rationalize "Did you mean" usage in Search API. Clearly identified Product requirements to design and innovate equivalent functionality on top of available Platform capabilities. Instituted the change to achieve **per annum savings of USD 220,000** operational cost with **ZERO customer impacting issues**.
- **Administered** PayPal Activities X-Geo team for design, planning and execution along with platform redesign to facilitate data migration of millions of PayPal customers following Geo regulatory compliance norms. **Led the delivery** of Activities platform capabilities to enable delightful end-to-end customer experiences for core PayPal payments products successfully launched in China.

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Bengaluru, KA

Software Engineer 3 (PayPal Activity Services Team)

02/20-03/22

- **Managed a team of 15+ engineers (over 1.5 years)** for executing the Enterprise initiative to decommission **4 legacy behemoth services** that were 10+ years old. Effectively planned resources and created year long roadmaps that resulted in **eliminating USD 700,000 infra expenditure per annum**, killed **100,000+ lines of code** and **25X+ performance improvements** in 7 Product searches.
- **Spearheaded** PayPal Activities X-Geo enablement. Led a team of 8 engineers to manage delivery, execution & quality with driving critical design discussions to power key PayPal revenue capabilities.
- Stepped up and identified key items that need to be completed for **China Financial Audit** regulatory compliance. Quickly built small teams, brought all hands on deck, and delegated tasks to accomplish deliverables in a tight timeline. Navigated across the board and created a 1-pager for sharing clarity. Supported **30+ POCs** across PayPal on this to win as One team.
- **Led a group of 3** to optimize Search API **latency by 20X** via implementing a re-architected parallelised database read pattern.
- **Redesigned a scalable architecture** that minimized customer perceived latency by **3X** for displaying "Actions in Activities" from typical **3.5s to less than 1s**.
- **Platform owner** moderating standardized development practices with **500+ high quality code reviews**.

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Bengaluru, KA

Software Engineer 2 (PayPal Activity Services Team)

02/17-02/20

- Co-ordinated with cross functional groups and **directed a team of 5 engineers** to build **Enterprise Audit capability** for Large Enterprise merchants operating in 10+ economies serving millions of customers.
- **Single handedly ran development** of team's externalized APIs on PayPal developer portal that allows 3rd party, internal & external developers to discover and consume PayPal products. **Rectified 50+ Product issues** for correctness and revamped for ease of understanding.
- Cut down feature **time to market by 3X** via incorporating self-serve coded architecture in platform services.
- Remediated functional defects to establish **100X latency improvements** in non-performant filtering operations.
- **Spearheaded platform integrations** projecting "Million-dollar" transaction value with Partners like Android Pay, Samsung Pay, Apple etc.
- **Recovered USD 100,000 per annum** of legacy maintenance cost by customizing existing API for migration.
- **Steered Security upgrade initiative** that modeled applications to authenticate internal / external clients along with classification-based data encryption over network transmission to safeguard customer's information.
- **Engineered** "Refund credit ETA tracker" capability from scratch **reducing daily 5K customer contacts**.
- **Innovated CI Jobs dashboard** addressing countless developer pain points and **saving 10K+ developer hours**.

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Bengaluru, KA

Software Engineer 1 (PayPal Activity Services Team)

07/15-02/17

- **Coded & performed the stack migration** of 2 customer facing APIs with **300M+ daily requests & serving 2B+ records daily** to **slash deployment duration by 97.5%**.

- Primary contact for investigating & **resolving P0/P1 critical issues** from prime merchants like Intuit, Google, Microsoft, Facebook accounting for “Million-dollar” transaction value **with servicing 100+ Jira issues**.
- Accelerated the execution of **platform integrations** within a month for Funds-In-Funds-Out offerings facilitating “**Billion-dollar**” transaction value for PayPal and Partners like Google, Xoom, Skype, Facebook etc.
- Simplified standard application logging and created a bunch of micro services coupled with detailed documentation **enabling 5X faster assessment** of Customer reported issues.

VICTORIA UNIVERSITY OF WELLINGTON

Summer Intern

Wellington, NZ

05/14-07/14

- Independently worked on the project – Parallel Computing in large network Load Flow Analysis.
- **Improved** computational **speed by 5X** with **50%+ drop** in resources consumption. Conceptualized an algorithm that implemented parallel processing techniques on inherently serial algorithms using Network division scheme.

EDUCATION

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GUWAHATI

Assam, India

Bachelor of Technology in Electronics and Electrical Engineering with Minor in Computer Science and Engineering

GPA: 8.93/10

07/11-05/15

- Awarded **Institute Silver Medal** for securing highest cumulative performance index in EEE dept. 2015 Batch.
- Secured **All India Rank 4531** ranking “amongst top 0.5% of the 1Million students” competing for the engineering entrance exam in India.
- Presented **UG Thesis** on “Real time transient simulation of large transmission networks” based on Electromagnetic transient program via parallel simulation on FPGA using ISE (Xilinx) hardware language.
- **Major courses:** Data structure and Algorithms, Software Engineering, Operating systems and networks, Theory of Computation, Digital Signal processing, Advanced Control Systems, Probability, Pattern Recognition and Machine Learning, Multivariable Calculus.

KEY SKILLS

People-Process-Program-Escalation Management, Coaching & Mentorship, Agile Leadership, Budgeting-Hiring-Resourcing Management (Attrition & Layoff), Performance Management, Systems Design, Customer champion, Autonomy & Collaboration, Accountability & Ownership, Driving Consensus, Excellence and Craftsmanship, Curiosity and growth mindset, Grit Courage & Bias for action, Comfortable with Ambiguity, Teamwork with Respect Empathy & Humility, Quality Champion, Designing Scalable solutions, Thinking Functional & Non-Functional Requirements, Enhancing Developer Productivity & One Team Behaviour, Conflict Resolution.

TECHNOLOGY

Micro-service architecture, Java, Spring Boot, REST, C++, ASF API, SQL, GIT, Bash scripting, Messaging with Queues/Kafka, Jenkins ECI / ECD, JIRA, Technical documentation, TDD with Junit, Functional Testing with TestNG, Docker, Production deployments, Swagger Open API, API Product documentation.

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- Awarded with PayPal’s prestigious **Trailblazer Award** under **Innovation Architect** category in **2025**.
- Secured Distinction with **81/100 score** in Professional Diploma in **Coaching and Mentoring from Kingstown college, Ireland**, Nov’24 - Jun’25
- Secured **Glint performance score 91/100 that is 14 points above Paypal Management score** and **highest in PayPal Consumer Org in Sep’2023** by effectively removing barriers to execution, driving org alignment, engagement within own and cross functional teams, uplifting career opportunities and demonstrating robustness in strategic direction amidst changing senior leadership, product gaps and market dynamics.
- **Attained** PayPal Manager benchmark **certification** for **Managing at PayPal Successfully** in **2024**.
- **Recognised in PayPal Star of Month Apr 2021** for successfully bringing SLA and Availability improvements with **USD 680,000 annual savings** migrating from Legacy systems. Effective demonstration of Collaboration, Inclusion and One team behaviors in execution and success of X-Geo China milestone.
- **Recognised in PayPal Heroes 2020** for showcasing persistence, sense of ownership in work, building scalable solutions and significantly reducing time spent by team on customer support in challenging pandemic period.
- **Awarded 12 Spot Rewards from PayPal** for being the Top performer towards Ownership, Quality, Ensuring Milestone delivery, Design, Driving Productivity, Optimizing the core APIs and Tech support.
- **Received 11 Bravo!** shout-outs from fellow Engineers and Management at PayPal towards showcasing Effective Collaboration, One Team behavior, being Customer champion and leading with Innovative solutions.

- **Secured position** in PayPal **Agile Championship Program 2019** out of 50+ competing participants.
- **Ranked 1st** across PayPal Bangalore center in Cyber Security **SecForce championship 2019**.
- Received **Certificate of appreciation** from PayPal Talent Acquisition team for conducting multiple rounds of quality interviews with positive feedback from 30+ candidates to recruit the best talent at PayPal.
- **Secured Internship** in Victoria University of Wellington, New Zealand **amongst top applicants** from the batch and **awarded scholarship** for the same during May–July 2014.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Personality : **ENFJ-A** (16personalities) & **Achiever, Strategic, Learner, Analytical, Arranger** (Gallup)

Attained : C1 with an [overall 7.5 out of 9](#) band score in International English Language Testing System.

Community : PayPal Gives volunteer' 2017-2020. Achieved 3rd position in Shadow Play (Hostel team), Manthan'2012. Part of Organising team, Half Marathon, Technique'2013. Qualified NSO-Badminton Athlete. Marketing Advisor for Shoplik.com leading with 40X growth, Alcheringa'2012.

Interests: Playing Badminton, Mathematical game "Sudoku", Travelling (Exploring new places and cuisines)